



Overwatch' novel?

An 'Overwatch' illustrated graphic novel has been scheduled to release in 2017
digit.in/Ovrwatchnov



LG's action cam!

LG has released action camera LTE in South Korea
digit.in/lgLTEactcam

Another common error is not completing the prescribed schedule and stopping the antibiotics early, just because the infection appears to have vanished. Not just humans, even livestock are fed antibiotics, which becomes another avenue for the natural development of superbugs. Overall, the increased availability and usage of antibiotics is increasing the number of antibiotic resistant bacterial infections. A very significant, yet oft overlooked facet of this whole issue is the waste from the pharmaceutical factories, which goes straight to

superbugs. To quote a Swedish scientist who tested the waters for antibiotics, "Some pharmaceuticals were [of] higher [concentration] in the water than in the blood of a patient who takes medication." With these levels of concentrated antibiotics in the river, the research group also found many strains of environmental bacteria that had grown resistance to the drugs. Thanks to bacteriophages and the aforementioned lateral gene transfer, it wouldn't be too hard for these genes to find their way to human pathogens. Once

normally effective drugs. Neonatologists are starting to consider that many of the superbug infections come not from the environment, but from the mother, thriving in the bodies of pregnant women.

Our country's well-known state of hygiene and sanitation, combined with our collective usage of antibiotics, makes our country the prime location for superbugs to survive, evolve and thrive. Although, the worst is yet to come. All these superbugs are resistant to many, or a few, antibiotics, but none of them is resistant to all antibiotics... yet. It's just a matter of time and gene transfers until some Superbug collects them all. That would indeed be a dark day for humanity, throwing us back to the pre-penicillin era. Disease will spread in every direction, the most common (currently treatable) infections claiming lives on the level of a calamity. All medicines will be rendered impotent, except the most risky and those with dangerous side-effects. The best shot at getting rid of the infection would be to sever the infected body part. A whole generation with so many amputations. The superbug will create a calamity more disastrous than anything we have ever seen. A piece of DNA that encodes the countermeasure to every weapon humanity can devise, being passed around freely among pathogens, who in turn are being passed around freely among humans, much to our own demise. The enemy lifeform wins.

It is no surprise that nature has a better grasp over bio-chemistry than we can ever hope to achieve, but perhaps it is foolish for us to be fighting nature, instead of using it and learning from it. After all, we aren't the only other life form who have to deal with bacteria. If you can see where this is going, rest assured, the most promising weapons against superbugs will come from nature itself. That too from an insect most of us despise, the cockroach. The brain tissue (only) of cockroaches has been found to contain more effective antibiotics that work against specific superbugs, as presented in a meeting of the Microbiology Society. Almost seems logical in retrospect, as cockroaches survive in the dirtiest conditions, which would mean that they have already adapted. The key to defeating the superbug, may literally lie in cockroaches' brains. How's that for a plot twist from real life? 



The fate of the future lies in a petri dish.

rivers and streams. Even though the water is officially 'treated', many villages downstream (whose livelihood depends heavily on the natural water) have recently started facing dire problems. This is because the official 'treatment' doesn't even include any check for antibiotics in the water. Back around the year 2000, the fish in the lakes that these rivers feed started floating up dead, and since then, many children and farmers have developed diseases that they haven't seen or heard of before. Furthermore, many of these diseases are being found to be drug resistant, a sure sign of

they do, these superbug infections can easily spread like wildfire. In fact, this has already been happening. The government has programs to increase the percentage of babies delivered in hospitals, with the aim of reducing infant mortality rates. However, most of these hospitals are now overburdened, with two or three women delivering in a single bed. Moreover, sanitation and hygiene are grossly overlooked, as many district hospitals have contaminated water, a lack of soap and unsanitary toilets. This has led to a large number of infections in newborns that are resistant to multiple